PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Hot Oil & Scalp Massage

Follow each oil maker's instructions and your state board rules on scalp massage and shampooing.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. No lice, infection, open sores or sunburn on the scalp. Defer and refer if found.

ALLERGY CHECK

Ask about nut, seed, fragrance and essential oil allergies. If unsure: nut-free, unscented.

PRE-SERVICE

Ask about neck, back or shoulder problems and pregnancy. Agree on pressure and the oil blend.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Hands washed ☐ Fresh towels, cape, neck strip ☐ Bed and bowl disinfected ☐ Oil decanted, no double-dipping ☐ Essential oils diluted [1–2%] ☐ Towels warming, neck support in place

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & consent**	5 min	Review health changes and allergies; confirm signed consent.
2	**Position**	2 min	Padded neck support, neutral neck, no sharp backward tilt.
3	**Warm & test oil**	2 min	Warm per maker; test on your inner wrist. Warm, never hot.
4	**Choose blend**	2 min	Oils at [1–2%] or fragrance-free; let the client smell it.
5	**Apply oil**	5 min	Section the hair; apply oil to the scalp with fingertips.
6	**Scalp massage**	10–15 min	Fingertip pads, slow circles, no nails. Check pressure often.
7	**Neck & shoulders**	10 min	Long strokes; no pressure on the front or sides of the neck.
8	**Warm towel rest**	10–20 min	Wrap in a warm, not hot, towel. Check comfort; dim lights.
9	**Shampoo out**	5–10 min	Lukewarm water, wrist-tested; shampoo twice. Or take home.
10	**Sit up & finish**	5 min	Sit up slowly; check for dizziness. Towel dry, comb gently.
11	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Review sheet and card. Suggest next visit in [2–4] weeks.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Oil warm, never hot; tested on your wrist every time
- Leftover decanted oil discarded, never poured back
- No pressure on the front or sides of the neck
- Oily towels washed well, never left piled warm

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Oil too hot or a red spot: stop. Cool running water for 20 minutes; refer if it blisters.
- Lip, face or throat swelling or wheezing: stop and call 911. Client uses their own epinephrine.
- Pain, tingling or numbness during massage: stop, ease off and reposition.
- Itching, rash or hives: wash the oil out with mild shampoo, cool compress, note the oil.
- Oil in the eye: flush with cool clean water for 15 minutes; seek care if it stays sore.
- Dizziness, vision spots, slurred speech or facial droop: sit up slowly; call 911 for stroke signs.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Oil · carrier	Essential oils · %	Pressure · areas	Rest time
Shampooed or taken home	**Scalp notes**	**Reaction or none**	**Next visit · initials**